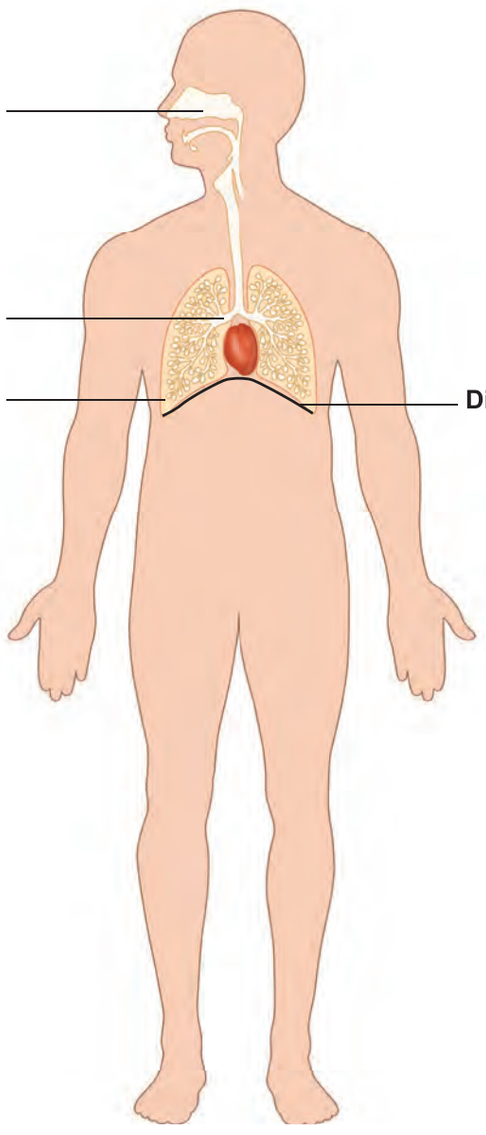
6.4 Respiratory System

Respiratory system is involved in exchange of respiratory gases and there by helps us to breathe. The human respiratory system consists of nostrils, nasal cavity, pharynx, larynx, trachea, bronchi and lungs. It helps in the movement of air in and out of the body. Exchange of O_2 and CO_2 occurs between air in the lung and blood. The entry of food into the wind pipe is prevented by a flap like structure called **Epiglottis**.

Lungs

Lungs are the main respiratory organ. They are located within the chest cavity. The trachea, commonly called **windpipe**, is a tube supported by cartilaginous rings that connects the pharynx and larynx to the lungs, allowing the passage of air. The trachea divides into right and left bronchi and enter into the lungs. They divide further and ends in small air sacs called **alveoli**. The lungs are covered by a double layered **pleura**. Diffusion of gases (O_2 and CO_2) occurs across the alveolar membrane.

Respiratory System



A5JCDX

When we inhale, where does the air go?

Nostrils
↓
Nasal cavity
↓
Pharynx
↓
Larynx
↓
Trachea
↓
Bronchus
↓
Bronchiole
↓
Alveolus

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